



All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam

The **All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam** (trans. All India Anna Dravidian Progressive Federation; abbr. **AIADMK**) is an Indian regional political party with the most influence in the union territory of Puducherry and state of Tamil Nadu. It is a Dravidian party adhering to the policies of socialism and secularism based on the principles of C. N. Annadurai collectively coined as *Annaism*.^[13] The party is one of the most successful political outfits in Tamil Nadu and has won the majority in the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly most number of times (seven).^[14] As of 2025, it is the main opposition party in the legislative assembly. The party is headquartered at Puratchi Thalaivar M.G.R. Maaligai located at Royapettah in Chennai.^[15]

The party was founded on 17 October 1972 after a breakaway from the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK). M. G. Ramachandran launched the party, which was earlier registered by Anakaputhur Ramalingam, and became the first general secretary. It was founded after Ramachandran was expelled from the DMK by its president M. Karunanidhi after he demanded the accounts of the party as the party treasurer.^{[16][17]} The party won the elections to the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly three times consecutively in 1977, 1980, and 1985 under the leadership of Ramachandran, who served as the chief minister of Tamil Nadu from 1977 to 1987.^[18]

After Ramachandran's death in December 1987, the party was split briefly between Ramachandran's wife V. N. Janaki and J. Jayalalithaa. The party was led by Jayalalithaa from January 1988 till her death in December 2016. Jayalalithaa served as the chief minister of Tamil Nadu five times.^[19] She was popular among the party cadres, and was fondly referred to as "Amma" (Mother).^{[20][21]}

After Jayalalithaa's death and brief tussle for leadership, the party was under the dual leadership of O. Panneerselvam and Edappadi K. Palaniswami as coordinator and joint coordinator respectively from August 2017 23 June 2022.^{[22][23][24]} Paneerselvan succeeded Jayalilathaa as the chief minister briefly, before Palaniswami occupied the position from February 2017 to May 2021. Since 11 July 2022, the party has been led by Palaniswami, who serves as the general secretary.^[25]

Ideology and policies

The AIADMK sought to depoliticise the education policy of the government by not insisting that education be in the Tamil language. Policies of the AIADMK were targeted at the poorer segments of Tamil society—the poor, rickshaw pullers, and destitute women—and centralising the massive Puratchi Thalaivar M.G.R. Nutritious Meal Programme for children.^[26] There was ambivalence towards the reservation policy and the interests of farmers. The party functions on the principles and the ideals of E. V. Ramasami and the former chief ministers of Tamil Nadu C. N. Annadurai, M. G. Ramachandran and J. Jayalalithaa.^[27]

The AIADMK posted an array of welfare schemes targeting the human development index of the state. The AIADMK has schemes listed in the election manifestos covering segments of the population, including fishermen, farmers, and schoolchildren. Until the 2000s, the parties had welfare programmes such as maternity leave, subsidies for public transportation, and educational grants. After the 2000s, the parties started competing at an increasing level for the distribution of consumer goods. The

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Abbreviation	AIADMK
General Secretary	Edappadi K. Palaniswami
Parliamentary Chairperson	M. Thambidurai
Rajya Sabha Leader	M. Thambidurai
Treasurer	Dindigul C. Sreenivasan
Founder	M. G. Ramachandran
Founded	17 October 1972
Split from	Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam
Headquarters	Puratchi Thalaivar M.G.R. Maaligai , 226, V.P. Raman Salai , Royapettah , Chennai – 600014, Tamil Nadu , India
Newspaper	Namadhu Amma (Tamil) ^[1]
Student wing	AIADMK Students' Wing
Youth wing	M.G.R. Youth Wing
Women's wing	AIADMK Women's Wing
Labour wing	Anna Thozhirsanga Peravai
Peasant's wing	AIADMK Agriculture Wing
Ideology	 Populism^[2] Socialism^[3] Welfarism^[4] Secularism^[5] Regionalism^[6] Social justice^[7] Tamil nationalism^{[8][9]} Centre-left^{[10][11]}
Political position	Centre-left ^{[10][11]}
Colours	Green
ECI Status	State party ^[12]
Alliance	▪ National Alliance NDA (1998-1999),(2004), (2019-2023), (since 2025) ▪ Regional Alliances AIADMK-led Alliance (Tamil Nadu) Former Alliances ▪ Congress alliance (1977-1979; 1984-1988; 1989-1996; 1999-2002) (Tamil Nadu) ▪ Janata Alliance (1979-1980) (Tamil Nadu) ▪ Third Front (2009) ▪ Left Front (1973-1984); (1999-2002); (2009-2014)

AIADMK government distributed free bicycles to class 11 and 12 students during its tenure of 2001–06. In its manifesto for the 2006 assembly elections, the DMK promised free colour televisions in competition with other parties. The competition continued during the 2011 assembly elections, when both parties announced free laptops for school students and mixers, fans, and blenders for the public.^[28]

Culture

The party remains firm in its support for the "two-language policy", in opposition to demands to have Hindi as the sole lingua franca language, where Tamil and English are the two main languages of Tamil Nadu.^[29] The party provided ₹1 lakh (US\$1,200) for temples of local deities in 2016.^[30]

Economy

In 2012, the AIADMK-led government announced the "Vision 2023" document, which embodied a strategic plan for infrastructure development that included raising the per capita income of residents to \$10 thousand per annum, matching the Human Development Index to that of developed countries by 2023, providing high-quality infrastructure all over the state, and making Tamil Nadu the knowledge capital and innovation hub of India.^[31] This project had three components: the overall vision document, the compilation of the project profile, and the road map.^[32] In the spring of 2019, the party lauded the economic policies of the Narendra Modi-led government, stating that the government had ushered in economic stability and made the country a "decisive player" in regional economics, and voiced support for the Goods and Services Tax (GST), which had been opposed by their rival, the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam.^[33]

During the AIADMK regime, Tamil Nadu was the best-performing big state overall from 2018 to 2021. With a gross state domestic product of \$290 billion, or ₹21.6 lakh crore, Tamil Nadu became India's second-largest economy.^{[34][35][36]}

Social justice

In 1980, the AIADMK under M. G. Ramachandran reversed his decision on economic criteria after the AIADMK faced a close defeat in the Indian general election in Tamil Nadu. He further raised the quota for the backward classes from 31% to 50%, bringing the total reservation to 68%.^[37] In 1993, the AIADMK government under J. Jayalalithaa passed the Tamil Nadu Backward Classes, Scheduled Castes, and Scheduled Tribes Bill, 1993, in the Assembly (Act 45 of 1994).^[38] The bill was sent to the president for approval. The government led a cross-party committee of Tamil Nadu politicians to Delhi to meet with the central government. She also demanded that the government of Tamil Nadu's act be placed in the ninth schedule of the Indian Constitution, ensuring that the law cannot be challenged in any court.^[39] Later, on 19 July 1994, the presidential assent was received, and it confirmed the 69% reservation for Tamil Nadu. On 20 February 2016, the Jayalalithaa-led AIADMK government passed the Tamil Nadu Municipal Laws (Amendment) Act, 2016, and the Tamil Nadu Panchayats (Amendment) Act, 2016, in the Tamil Nadu legislative assembly, enhancing the reservation for women from 33% to 50% in local bodies such as municipal corporations, municipalities, town panchayats, and village panchayats of the state.^{[40][41]}

State water policy

In 2006, the AIADMK initiated a case in the Supreme Court to uphold the state's rights on the Mullaperiyar Dam issue. As a result, in May 2014, a Supreme Court verdict allowed Tamil Nadu to increase the storage level in the Mullaperiyar Dam to 142 feet from 136 feet and struck down the unconstitutional law enacted by the government of Kerala in 2006 restricting the storage level to 136 feet.^{[42][43]} This Supreme Court decision ensured the farmers' and people's livelihoods in the southern districts of Tamil Nadu.^[44] In February 2013, the government of India notified the final award of the Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal (CWDT) on the directions of the Supreme Court.^[45] After 22 years of legal battle, chief minister of Tamil Nadu J. Jayalalithaa called it a "tremendous achievement" of her government that the state had received due justice.^{[46][47]} Then Jayalalithaa said that it was the happiest day of her life and the happiest day for the farmers in Tamil Nadu; she recalled her famous fast-unto-death at Marina Beach in 1993.^{[48][49][50]}

Seats in Rajya Sabha 4 / 245

Seats in Lok Sabha 0 / 543

Seats in Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly 60 / 234

Number of states and union territories in government 0 / 31

Election symbol



Party flag



Website

AIADMK (<https://aiadmk.com/>)

Politics of India · Political parties · Elections



C.N. Annadurai, ideologue of the party

Environment and nature

The AIADMK was one of two parties, along with the [BJP](#), to not voice opposition against a ban on cattle slaughter through the national [Prevention of Cruelty to Animals Act](#).^[51] However, it has sought an exemption in the Act regarding traditional bull fighting; the party supports popular opinion in [Tamil Nadu](#) that traditional bull fighting, known as [Jallikattu](#), should not be banned by the [central government](#) due to an [APEX court](#) ruling against animal cruelty.^[52] During the controversy, the party demanded that the animal rights organisation [PETA](#) be banned.^{[53][54]}

In March 2017, the AIADMK government led by [Edappadi K. Palaniswami](#) implemented the [Kudimaramathu Scheme](#) to rejuvenate water bodies with the participation of agriculturalists, reviving the age-old practice of community participation in the maintenance and management of tank irrigation systems.^{[55][56]} In May 2018, the AIADMK government ordered the closure of the [Sterlite Copper](#) factory in [Thoothukkudi](#) in the interest of the people, knowing that the air and water in the city are being heavily polluted by the factory, which has been at the centre of violent protests by locals to protect and improve the environment.^{[57][58]} In February 2020, the AIADMK government declared the [Cauvery Delta](#) region a protected special agriculture zone.^[59] This announcement was widely hailed by political parties and farmer organisations.^{[60][61]} The AIADMK opposes the building of the [Mekedatu Dam](#), which could reduce water flows into [Tamil Nadu](#) and negatively affect quality of life for residents and agriculture.^{[62][63]}

History

M. G. Ramachandran era (1972–87)

The party was founded on 17 October 1972, as *Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam* (ADMK) by [M. G. Ramachandran](#) (M.G.R.), a veteran [Tamil film](#) star and popular politician. It was set up as a breakaway faction from the [Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam](#) (DMK) after its president [M. Karunanidhi](#) expelled him from the party for demanding an account as the party treasurer.^[64] M.G.R., who wanted to start a new political party, then incorporated it into [Anakaputhur](#) Ramalingam's party, which had registered under the name *ADMK*. He then quoted, "I joined the party started by an ordinary cadre" and gave the post of [Member of the Legislative Council](#) to Ramalingam. Later, M.G.R. prefixed the *All India* (AI) tag to the party's name to protect the party during the [Maintenance of Internal Security Act](#) (MISA).^[65] Since its inception, the relationship between the AIADMK and the DMK has been marked by mutual hatred. M.G.R. used his fan club to build the party cadre; he claims his party recruited more than a million members in the first two months. [C. N. Annadurai](#)'s ideologue and movie producer turned politician [R. M. Veerappan](#) was the key architect in unifying M.G.R. fan clubs and further consolidating the party structure in the 1970s.^[66] Other key leaders, such as [Nanjil K. Manoharan](#) and [S. D. Somasundaram](#), played major roles in consolidation, and [Pavalar M. Muthusamy](#) was elected as the first presidium chairman of the party.^[67] Then [Communist Party of India](#) (CPI) state secretary [M. Kalyanasundaram](#) strongly backed M.G.R. and played a crucial role in shaping his political career by teaming up with the fledgling AIADMK. M.G.R., along with [Kalyanasundaram](#), presented to the [governor of Tamil Nadu](#), [K. K. Shah](#), a charge against the Karunanidhi-led DMK government in November 1972.^[68] The party's first victories were the wins of [K. Maya Thevar](#) in the [Dindigul](#) parliamentary bye-election in May 1973 and of [C. Aranganayagam](#) in the [Coimbatore West](#) assembly bye-election a year later.^[69] On 2 April 1973, the AIADMK emerged as the third-largest political party in Tamil Nadu, represented by 11 MLAs in the assembly. By January 1976, the AIADMK emerged as the second-largest political party with 16 MLAs in the assembly. Extending its support to the [National Emergency](#) between 1975 and 1977, the party grew very close to the [Indian National Congress](#) (INC).^[70]



M. G. Ramachandran, the first general secretary of the party

In 1974, AIADMK contested its first assembly election in [Puducherry](#) with its alliance partner [CPI](#) and won 14 of 30 seats in the legislative assembly. On 6 March 1974, [S. Ramassamy](#) was sworn in as [chief minister of Puducherry](#) for the short-lived government and became the first [chief minister](#) from the party after its establishment.^[71]

In [Tamil Nadu](#), the [Karunanidhi-led state government](#) was dismissed by the [Indira Gandhi-led central government](#) on corruption charges in 1976. The AIADMK swept to power, defeating the DMK in the [1977 assembly election](#).^{[72][73]} On 30 June 1977, M.G.R. was sworn in as the [chief minister of Tamil Nadu](#), becoming the first actor to become the [chief minister](#) in the Republic of India.^[74] In the [1977 general election](#), the party won 18 seats, and in the [Puducherry assembly election](#), it won 14 seats and formed the government. On 2 July 1977, [S. Ramassamy](#) was sworn in as [chief minister of Puducherry](#) for a second term.^[75] In 1979, the AIADMK became the first [Dravidian](#) and regional party to join the [Union Cabinet](#) in the history of the Republic of India.^[76] [Sathiavani Muthu](#) and [Aravinda Bala Pajanor](#) were the members of parliament who joined the short-lived [Union Ministry](#) led by [Prime Minister Charan Singh](#).^{[77][78][79]}

The relationship between the AIADMK and the [INC](#) slowly became strained. In the [1980 general election](#), the INC aligned with the DMK, and the alliance won 37 out of the 39 state parliamentary seats. The AIADMK won just two seats. After returning to power, [Indira Gandhi](#) dismissed many [state governments](#) belonging to the [opposition](#) parties, including the AIADMK government in [Tamil Nadu](#).^[80]

In 1980, AIADMK contested its second assembly election in Tamil Nadu, allied with left parties, and won as the single majority party in the state assembly with 129 of 234 seats.^[81] On 9 June 1980, M.G.R. was sworn in as chief minister of Tamil Nadu for a second term, whereas the opposition DMK continued its alliance with the central government ruling INC(I) following the last general election and got a completely reversed result. The victory solidified M.G.R.'s position as a prominent leader in Tamil Nadu, further strengthening the AIADMK's influence in the state's political landscape. Meanwhile, the DMK faced significant challenges as it grappled with the consequences of its alliance, leading to a period of introspection and re-evaluation of its strategies for future elections.^{[82][83]}

On 4 June 1982, M.G.R.'s famous on-screen pair and popular actress J. Jayalalithaa joined the party. Her entry into politics marked the beginning of her rapid ascent within the party. On 28 January 1983, general secretary P. U. Shanmugam appointed her as the propaganda secretary.^[84] She was elected as a member of parliament to Rajya Sabha on 3 April 1984 by defeating Arcot N. Veerasamy of the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam via indirect election.^[85]

In the 1984 general election, the party again aligned with the INC, and the alliance won 37 out of the 39 state parliamentary seats.^[86] During the 1984 assembly election, M.G.R. was in failing health and hospitalised in the United States for treatment, undergoing a kidney transplant; even though he was not in the country, the party won the election by winning 132 seats.^{[87][88]} M.G.R. returned to Tamil Nadu on 4 February 1985 following his recovery.^[89] He was sworn in as chief minister of Tamil Nadu for the third term on 10 February 1985. Many political historians consider M.G.R.'s persona and charisma at this time to be "infallible" and a logical continuation of his on-screen "good lad" image, strengthened by his "mythical status" in the minds of the masses. M.G.R. continued to enjoy popular support in his third term until his death. He died on 24 December 1987 and became the second chief minister in Tamil Nadu to die in office after Anna.^{[90][91]}

Succession conflict between the Jayalalithaa and Janaki factions

A week after following M.G.R.'s death, on 1 January 1988, member of parliament J. Jayalalithaa was elected general secretary of the party by the prominent members, and it was ratified by the party general council convened by her the next day.^[92] On the other hand, M.G.R.'s wife, V. N. Janaki Ramachandran, was elected the party's legislative leader by R. M. Veerappan and 98 other members of the legislative assembly.^[93] She was sworn in as the state's first female chief minister on 7 January 1988, becoming the first actress to become the chief minister in the Republic of India, and served for 23 days until the state assembly was dissolved and president's rule was imposed on 30 January 1988.^[94] The party began to split due to infighting, splitting into two factions, one led by Jayalalithaa and the other led by Janaki.^[95] As the 1989 assembly election approaches, on 17 December 1988, the Election Commission of India froze the AIADMK electoral symbol "Two Leaves", called the Brahmastra of the party, and allotted Jayalalithaa the "Rooster" electoral symbol in the name of AIADMK(J) and Janaki the "Twin Pigeon" electoral symbol in the name of AIADMK(JA).^[96] In the 1989 assembly election, both factions contested the election with their symbols and alliances, which led the DMK to regain power after 13 years, with M. Karunanidhi returning as the chief minister of Tamil Nadu for the third term. Due to its split, the AIADMK suffered heavily in the election, with the Jayalalithaa and Janaki factions winning only 27 and 2 seats, respectively. Jayalalithaa-led AIADMK(J) became the main opposition party in the Tamil Nadu legislative assembly. The Janaki-led AIADMK(JA) routed the election; she realised that politics wasn't her thing and chose to quit. On 7 February 1989, the factions merged under the leadership of Jayalalithaa.^[97] Thereafter, the chief election commissioner R. V. S. Peri Sastri unfroze the electoral symbol Two Leaves and granted it back to the Jayalalithaa-led united AIADMK on 8 February 1989. This pivotal moment marked a significant turnaround for the party, establishing Jayalalithaa as a formidable force in Tamil Nadu politics. With renewed emphasis on party unity and a clear electoral strategy, she began to work towards regaining public support and restoring the party's influence in the state.^[98]

J. Jayalalithaa era (1989–2016)

On 9 February 1989, J. Jayalalithaa was elected the party's legislative leader and became the first and only female leader of the opposition in the Tamil Nadu legislative assembly. She was the first actress to become the leader of the opposition in the Republic of India. On 25 March 1989, a barbaric attack was unleashed on Jayalalithaa by the DMK ministers and members of the legislative assembly in the presence of the chief minister M. Karunanidhi and the speaker M. Tamilkudimagan.^[99] During the attack, the bundles of papers, pads, and large books were thrown over her; also, her saree was pulled and torn, and some of her hair was grabbed. AIADMK legislators, including Su. Thirunavukkarasar and K. K. S. S. R. Ramachandran, tried hard to protect and eject her from the assembly.^[100] She came out of the assembly after a disastrous moment with her torn saree and deformed hair, drawing a parallel with the shameful disrobing of Draupadi in the epic Mahabharata, vowing to return to the assembly only after becoming the chief minister.^{[101][102]}

In the 1989 general election, the party allied with the Indian National Congress (INC), and the alliance won 39 of 40 seats it contested in Tamil Nadu and Puducherry. In January 1991, the Chandra Shekhar-led central government dismissed the Karunanidhi-led state government on charges that the constitutional machinery in the state had broken down.^[103] After Rajiv Gandhi's death, the AIADMK-led Alliance swept the 1991 assembly election and regained power. On 24 June 1991, Jayalalithaa was sworn in as the chief minister of Tamil Nadu,



J. Jayalalithaa, the longest served general secretary of the party

becoming the second actress to become the chief minister in the Republic of India.^[104] She also became the second female chief minister of Tamil Nadu after M.G.R.'s wife, V. N. Janaki Ramachandran. Political observers have ascribed the landslide victory to the anti-incumbent wave arising out of the assassination of the former prime minister by suspected Tamil separatists fighting for a homeland in neighbouring Sri Lanka.

In the 1996 assembly election, the AIADMK-led Alliance suffered a massive rout; the party only won 4 of 234 seats and not even got an opposition status in the assembly. Even the general secretary Jayalalithaa, lost to E. G. Sugavanam of DMK in the Bargur constituency, from where she was elected to become chief minister for her first term. The party also lost all the seats it contested in the 1996 general election.^[105]

From 1 January 1998 to 3 January 1998, the conference of the AIADMK Silver Jubilee Celebrations was held in Tirunelveli, led by the general secretary Jayalalithaa, and lakhs of party cadres and supporters attended the event.^[106] At the conference, the party virtually launched its general election campaign in Tamil Nadu and Puducherry in the presence of the alliance partners L. K. Advani of the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP), S. Ramadoss of the Pattali Makkal Katchi (PMK), Subramanian Swamy of the Janata Party (JP), Valappaddy K. Ramamurthy of the Tamizhaga Rajiv Congress (TRC), and Vaiko of the Marumalarchi Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (MDMK) participated in the conference ahead of the general election that year.^[107] During the 1998 general election, the AIADMK-led Alliance won 30 of 40 seats it contested in Tamil Nadu and Puducherry.^[108] Sedapatti R. Muthiah, M. Thambidurai, R. K. Kumar, and Kadambur M. R. Janarthanan were the members of parliament from AIADMK who joined the Union Ministry led by Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee.^[109] On 8 April 1999, AIADMK members of parliament resigned from the union ministry, and on 14 April 1999, Jayalalithaa submitted a letter to the president K. R. Narayanan, withdrawing its support for the Vajpayee-led central government, and the president called for a motion of no-confidence to be held in the parliament. On 12 October 1999, Vajpayee lost in a motion of no-confidence called by Jayalalithaa in a single vote, which led to the government's fall.^[110] This incident made the entire country look back at Jayalalithaa. In the 1999 general election, the AIADMK allied with the INC and left parties and won 14 of 40 seats it contested in Tamil Nadu and Puducherry.^[111]

In the 2001 assembly election, the AIADMK-led Alliance, consisting of the Tamil Maanila Congress (Moopanar) (TMC(M)), the Indian National Congress (INC), the Pattali Makkal Katchi (PMK), and the left parties, won 197 seats to the AIADMK's 132 and regained power.^[112] On 14 May 2001, Jayalalithaa was sworn in as chief minister of Tamil Nadu for a second term and became the second chief minister to take oath as a non-contested member in the assembly election after V. N. Janaki Ramachandran.^[104] Jayalalithaa was barred from contesting the election because of the conviction in the disproportionate asset case that occurred during her previous tenure.^[113] Due to the proceedings in a disproportionate asset case, she was prevented from holding office, so she was compelled to resign from the post.^[114] Then she appointed first-time elected member of the legislative assembly O. Panneerselvam as the legislative leader of the party. On 21 September 2001, he was sworn in as the chief minister of Tamil Nadu for the first term. Once the Supreme Court of India overturned her conviction and sentence in the case, Panneerselvam resigned from the post immediately on the morning of 2 March 2002, and on the same evening, Jayalalithaa was sworn in as chief minister for the third term.^[104]

In Jayalalithaa's second and third terms, she took many popular decisions, such as banning lottery tickets, restricting the liquor and sand quarrying businesses to government agencies, and banning tobacco product sales near schools and colleges.^[115] She encouraged women to join the state police force by setting up all-women's police stations and commissioning 150 women into the elite-level police commandos in 2003, a first in India.^[116] The women had the same training as men, which included handling weapons, detection and disposal of bombs, driving, horseback riding, and adventure sports. She dispatched a special task force in the name of Operation Cocoon, headed by K. Vijay Kumar and N. K. Senthamarai Kannan, to the Sathyamangalam forests in October 2004 to track down notorious sandalwood smuggler Veerappan.^[117] The operation was successful, as the special task force killed him on 18 October 2004.^{[118][119]}

Despite the popular measures taken by the Jayalalithaa-led government, the AIADMK-led Alliance lost all 40 seats it contested in the 2004 general election. The Democratic Progressive Alliance (DPA), consisting of all the major opposition parties in the state, swept the election.^[120]

In the 2006 assembly election, the party contested only with the support of the Marumalarchi Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (MDMK), Viduthalai Chiruthaigal Katchi (VCK) and a few other smaller parties, winning 69 seats, with the AIADMK winning 61 seats. The opposition's Democratic Progressive Alliance, comprising larger parties, won 163 seats, with the DMK winning 96 seats; the DMK is back in power but only as a minority government.^[121] In the history of Tamil Nadu, it was the first time the state had a hung assembly with a minority government. The AIADMK's electoral reversals continued in the 2009 general election. However, the party's performance was better than its debacle in 2004, and the AIADMK-led Alliance managed to win 12 seats, with the AIADMK winning 9 seats.^{[122][123]}

Following widespread corruption, a price rise, a power cut, and allegations of nepotism against the DMK government, in the 2011 assembly election, the AIADMK-led Alliance with parties like the left and actor-turned-politician Vijayakanth's Desiya Murpokku Dravida Kazhagam (DMDK) swept the polls, winning 203 seats, with the AIADMK winning 150,^[124] and on 16 May 2011, Jayalalithaa was sworn in as chief minister of Tamil Nadu for a fourth term.^[104] Her return to power marked a significant shift in the state's political landscape, as she implemented various welfare schemes aimed at improving the lives of the underprivileged.^[4] These initiatives garnered her considerable support, further solidifying her position in Tamil Nadu politics and effectively challenging the opposition's influence.

In Puducherry, the AIADMK allied with N. Rangasamy's All India N.R. Congress (AINRC) and won the 2011 assembly election, which was held in parallel with the Tamil Nadu assembly election.^[125] Rangasamy, on the other hand, formed the government without consulting the AIADMK and refused to share power with the pre-election alliance partner. So Jayalalithaa accused him of betraying the coalition.^[126]



Swearing-in Ceremony of the council of ministers headed by Jayalalithaa on 16 May 2011

On 9 February 2014, the general secretary of the AIADMK and the chief minister of Tamil Nadu Jayalalithaa donated a 13-kg gold armour to adorn the 3.5-foot-tall Pasumpon U. Muthuramalinga Thevar statue at the U. Muthuramalinga Thevar temple in Pasumpon, Ramanathapuram.^[127] This armour is kept safely in a locker at the Bank of India's Anna Nagar branch in Madurai. After the AIADMK treasurer signs the bank, the shield will be handed over to the treasurer, who will then hand it over to the temple trustees from October 28 to 30, which is the Guru Pooja and Thevar Jayanthi observed on October 30 every year.^[128]

The AIADMK's electoral performance continued to be excellent in the 2014 general election as well. It opted not to join any alliance and contested all seats in the state of Tamil Nadu and the union territory of Puducherry on its own.^[129] The party won an unprecedented 37 out of the 40 parliamentary constituencies it contested and emerged as the third largest party in the 16th Lok Sabha of the Indian Parliament.^[130] It was a massive victory that no other regional political party had ever achieved in the history of general elections.^[131]

On 29 August 2014, the chief minister of Tamil Nadu Jayalalithaa was elected as the general secretary of the party for the 7th consecutive term, making her the longest-serving general secretary of the party to date.^[132] Earlier, she was elected as general secretary on 1 January 1988, 9 February 1989, 23 June 1993, 23 September 1998, 10 September 2003,^[133] and 10 September 2008.^[134] During her longest tenure as general secretary, E. V. A. Vallimuthu,^[135] V. R. Nedunchezhiyan,^[135] K. Kalimuthu,^[136] Pulamaipithan,^[137] C. Ponnaiyan,^[138] and E. Madhusudhanan^[139] served as the presidium chairmen of the party.

On 27 September 2014, the chief minister of Tamil Nadu Jayalalithaa was convicted in the disproportionate assets case by a special court along with her associates V. K. Sasikala, Ilavarasi, and V. N. Sudhakaran and sentenced to four years' simple imprisonment. Jayalalithaa was also fined ₹100 crore, and her associates were fined ₹10 crore each.^[140] The case had political implications, as it was the first time a ruling chief minister had to step down on account of a court sentence.^[141]

Due to Jayalalithaa's dismissal, the minister for finance and public works of Tamil Nadu Panneerselvam was sworn in as chief minister of Tamil Nadu for a second term on 29 September 2014.^[142] Bail for Jayalalithaa was denied by the High Court and then moved to the Supreme Court, where it was granted on 17 October 2014. On 11 May 2015, the High Court of Karnataka said she was acquitted from that case,^[143] and on 23 May 2015, Jayalalithaa was sworn in as chief minister of Tamil Nadu for a fifth term.^[104]

In the 2016 assembly election, the chief minister of Tamil Nadu Jayalalithaa ran without allies and swept the polls by winning 135 of 234 seats.^[144] It was the most audacious decision taken by her for the spectacular victory that any political leader had ever made in the history of Tamil Nadu elections.^{[145][146]} On 23 May 2016, Jayalalithaa was sworn in as chief minister of Tamil Nadu for a sixth and last term.^[147]

On 22 September 2016, she was admitted to Apollo Hospital, Chennai, due to fever and dehydration.^[148] After a prolonged illness, she died on 5 December 2016 and became the third chief minister in Tamil Nadu to die in office after Anna and her mentor M.G.R.^{[149][150][151]}

Following her death, a robbery and murder took place at Jayalalithaa's Kodanadu estate on 24 April 2017. The incident later became a politically sensitive issue within the AIADMK and among the public.^{[152][153][154]}

Expansion beyond Tamil Nadu and Puducherry

Under the leadership of Jayalalithaa, the party spread beyond Tamil Nadu and Puducherry. It established state units in some other Indian states and union territories, like the Andaman and Nicobar Islands, Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, Kerala, Maharashtra, the National Capital Territory of Delhi, and Telangana. The party also has functionaries and supporters in other countries where Tamil people are present.

In Karnataka, the party had members in the state assembly from 1983 to 2004 and has influence in the Tamil-speaking areas of Bengaluru and Kolar.^[155] In Kerala, the party won a total of six wards in three panchayats in the local body elections.^[156]

In Andhra Pradesh, Kerala, and Maharashtra, the party has contested some legislative assembly elections but did not win a single seat in any of the elections.^[157]

V. K. Sasikala and T. T. V. Dhinakaran era (2016–17)

After Jayalalithaa's death on 5 December 2016, her close aide V. K. Sasikala was selected unanimously as the Acting General Secretary of the party on 31 December 2016.^{[158][159]} On 5 February 2017, she was selected as the leader of the legislative assembly as chief minister. O. Panneerselvam rebelled against Sasikala and reported that he had been compelled to resign as Chief Minister, bringing in a new twist to

Tamil Nadu politics. Due to a conviction in the [disproportionate assets case](#) against Jayalalithaa, Sasikala was sentenced to 4 years' imprisonment in the [Bengaluru Central Prison](#). Before that, she appointed [Edappadi K. Palaniswami](#) as legislative party leader (Chief Minister).

She also appointed her nephew and former treasurer of the party, [T. T. V. Dhinakaran](#), as the deputy general secretary of the AIADMK party.^[160] With the support of 123 MLAs, Palaniswami became [chief minister of Tamil Nadu](#).

On 23 March 2017, the Election Commission of India (ECI) gave separate party symbols to the two factions: O. Panneerselvam's faction, known as AIADMK (Puratchi Thalaivi Amma), got the "Electric Pole" symbol, and [Edappadi K. Palaniswami](#)'s faction, known as AIADMK (Amma), got the "Hat" symbol.^[161]

A [bye-election](#) was announced for the [Dr. Radhakrishnan Nagar](#) constituency, which was vacated due to Jayalalithaa's death. But the election commission cancelled the bye-election after evidence of large-scale bribery by the ruling AIADMK (Amma) surfaced. On 17 April 2017, Delhi police registered a case against Dhinakaran, who was also the candidate for AIADMK (Amma) for the bye-election at Dr. Radhakrishnan Nagar, regarding an allegation of attempting to bribe the Election Commission of India for the AIADMK's election symbol.^[162] However, the Central District Tis Hazari Courts granted him bail on the grounds that the police had failed to identify the allegedly bribed public official.

However, the chief minister, Edappadi K. Palaniswami, had a fallout with Dhinakaran and announced that the appointment of Dhinakaran as deputy general secretary was invalid. So he claims, "We are the real AIADMK, and 95% of its cadres are with us."

Expulsion of V. K. Sasikala and T. T. V. Dhinakaran

On 12 September 2017, the AIADMK general council, which had earlier appointed her, cancelled [V. K. Sasikala](#)'s appointment as general secretary and officially expelled her from the party as a primary member.^{[163][164]}

Earlier on 10 August 2017, [T. T. V. Dhinakaran](#) was sacked as deputy general secretary at the meeting headed by [Edappadi K. Palaniswami](#) at Puratchi Thalaivar M.G.R. Maaligai in Chennai.^{[165][164]}

After completing her imprisonment at Bengaluru Central Prison, Sasikala filed a case in the City Civil Court IV of [Chennai](#) in February 2021, but it upheld her dismissal as the [AIADMK general secretary](#) in April 2022.^[166] On 5 December 2023, the [Madras High Court](#) upheld her dismissal as the AIADMK general secretary.^[167]

O. Panneerselvam and Edappadi K. Palaniswami era (2017–22)

On 21 August 2017, both O. Panneerselvam and Edappadi K. Palaniswami factions of the AIADMK merged, and O. Panneerselvam was sworn in as the [Deputy Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu](#) with the portfolio of Finance. He also holds portfolios for housing, rural housing, housing development, the slum clearance board, accommodation control, town planning, urban development, and the [Chennai Metropolitan Development Authority](#). A dual leadership system was amended in the constitution of the party by removing the designation of general secretary and constituting the new designations for the party's leadership. O. Panneerselvam and Edappadi K. Palaniswami became the coordinator and joint coordinator of the AIADMK, respectively.^[168] On 4 January 2018, O. Panneerselvam was elected [Leader of the House](#) in the [Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly](#).

On 12 September 2017, the AIADMK general council decided to cancel V. K. Sasikala's appointment as acting general secretary and officially expel her from the party, though prominent members appointed to party posts by her were allowed to continue discharging their functions. Instead, the late [J. Jayalalithaa](#) was named the eternal general secretary of the AIADMK.^{[163][164]}

A day after the merger of two AIADMK factions, on 22 August 2017, 19 MLAs^[169] owing allegiance to ousted deputy general secretary [T. T. V. Dhinakaran](#) submitted letters to the [governor](#), expressing lack of confidence in [Chief Minister](#) Edappadi K. Palaniswami and withdrawing support from the government.^[169] 18 out of those 19 MLAs were disqualified from office by the [Speaker of the legislative assembly](#) upon recommendation from the AIADMK Chief Whip. After a prolonged legal battle, the Speaker's orders were upheld by the [Madras High Court](#), and bye-elections were held alongside the general parliamentary elections. On 23 November 2017, the [Election Commission of India](#) granted the "two leaves" symbol to the [O. Panneerselvam](#) and [Edappadi K. Palaniswami](#) camp.^[170]

On 24 February 2018, AIADMK's new mouthpiece, [Namadhu Amma](#), a Tamil daily newspaper, was launched, marking the 70th birth anniversary of the former [chief minister of Tamil Nadu](#) and the former general secretary of AIADMK, [J. Jayalalithaa](#), fondly known as [Amma](#).^{[171][172]} On 14 November 2018, the AIADMK launched [News J](#), named after the AIADMK former general secretary [J. Jayalalithaa](#), to replace [Jaya TV](#). News J is the 24×7 Tamil news channel operated and managed by Mantaro Network Private Limited.^{[173][174]}

Despite the popular measures taken by the government, in the [2019 Lok Sabha election](#), the party, in alliance with the BJP again, was humiliated, winning one of the 39 Lok Sabha seats from the state. The [Secular Progressive Alliance](#) (SPA), a DMK-led alliance consisting of all the major opposition parties in the state, swept the election by winning 38 seats.^[175]

In August 2020, there was a bustle in the party over the selection of the chief ministerial candidate.^[176] On 7 October 2020, the party coordinator and the deputy chief minister of Tamil Nadu O. Panneerselvam announced that the joint coordinator and the chief minister of Tamil Nadu Edappadi K. Palaniswami, would be the chief ministerial candidate for the upcoming 2021 assembly election.^[177]

In the 2021 assembly election, the AIADMK-led Alliance, consisting of the PMK, BJP, and a few other smaller parties, won 75 seats compared to the 159 seats won by the DMK-led Secular Progressive Alliance, which made the DMK form a majority government after the victory of the 1996 assembly election.^[178] After the election, the AIADMK emerged as the main opposition party in the assembly by winning 66 seats. On 10 May 2021, party joint coordinator Edappadi K. Palaniswami was unanimously elected as the leader of the opposition in the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly^[179] and on 14 June 2021, party coordinator O. Panneerselvam was elected as the deputy leader of the opposition in the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly.^[180]

On 15 October 2021, party coordinator O. Panneerselvam and joint coordinator Edappadi K. Palaniswami jointly released the notification stating that the headquarters of the party, which is located at V.P. Raman Salai, Royapettah, Chennai, will be named *Puratchi Thalaivar M.G.R. Maaligai* in memory of the party's founder and the former chief minister of Tamil Nadu M. G. Ramachandran.^[181] In December 2021, they both re-elected as co-ordinator and joint co-ordinator respectively.^[182]

Legal fight for the party by V. K. Sasikala and T. T. V. Dhinakaran

After that, V. K. Sasikala and T. T. V. Dhinakaran had appealed to the Delhi High Court, which rejected their appeal and said that O. Panneerselvam and Edappadi K. Palaniswami were the original AIADMK.

Following that, T. T. V. Dhinakaran filed an appeal with the Supreme Court of India on March 15, and the bench of the Chief Justice of India dismissed his appeal against the Delhi High Court's decision in favor of the O. Panneerselvam and Edappadi K. Palaniswami camp.

Following this, the General Council passed a resolution removing V. K. Sasikala from the post of General Secretary. V. K. Sasikala and T. T. V. Dhinakaran jointly filed a suit in the High Court challenging the decision of the General Council. Since it was a civil case, the case was transferred to the City Civil Court. During the hearing on 9 April 2021, Dinakaran told the court that he would withdraw from the case as he had started a party called Amma Makkal Munnetra Kazagam.^[183] At the same time, Sasikala told the court that she wanted to continue the case. The court dismissed her plea following an interlocutory application from AIADMK coordinator O. Panneerselvam and joint coordinator Edappadi K. Palaniswami.^[184]

Tensions with BJP

In June 2022, the AIADMK and BJP were at odds publicly.^[185] AIADMK organization secretary C. Ponnaiyan accused the BJP-led central government of stealing Tamil Nadu's revenue, as well as blaming AIADMK for election losses, the loss of minority community support, and "anti-Tamil" policies, particularly those affecting students.^[186] He also called the alliance an "electoral adjustment", claiming that the BJP was attempting to expand at the cost of the AIADMK in Tamil Nadu and that its ideology is diametrically opposite that of the AIADMK.^{[187][188]} The event reportedly had party cadres reiterating these sentiments, albeit in a lighter tone, and agreeing that the BJP was attempting to wrest control of the state's opposition from the AIADMK.^[185]

Leadership tussle between O. Panneerselvam and Edappadi K. Palaniswami

On 14 June 2022, citing the party's troubles in the polls, AIADMK district secretaries and other senior party members spoke out to shun the "dual leadership" system and came out publicly in favor of a strong unitary leader to strengthen the organization.

Supporters of Edappadi K. Palaniswami pushed for the change in the party's leadership structure by staging a political coup against AIADMK coordinator O. Panneerselvam, who had become weak within the party. According to many sources, of the AIADMK's 75 district secretaries, hardly 10 supported him. Of the party's 66 MLAs, only three were reportedly on O. Panneerselvam's side, and less than 20 percent of the party's general council members were behind him ahead of the crucial general council meeting on 23 June 2022, which was expected to elect the single leadership to the party.^[189]

On 23 June 2022, A. Thamizhman Hussain was unanimously elected as the Presidium Chairman of the party at a general council meeting held at the Shrivaaru Venkatachalapathy Palace in Vanagaram, Chennai.^{[190][191]} On the same day, Presidium Chairman A. Thamizhman Hussain announced that the next general council meeting of the party would be held on 11 July 2022.^{[192][193]}

On 30 June 2022, Edappadi K. Palaniswami wrote a letter to O. Panneerselvam asserting the latter ceased to be the party coordinator as the amendments made to the party's bylaw in the December 2021 executive committee meeting were not recognized in the general council meeting held on 23 June 2022.^{[194][195]}

Expulsion of O. Panneerselvam

In the general council meeting held on 11 July 2022, the general council members passed the resolution and expelled the former coordinator O. Panneerselvam,^[196] the former deputy coordinator R. Vaithilingam, P. H. Manoj Pandian, and J. C. D. Prabhakar from their respective posts and primary membership in the party for "anti-party" activities.^{[197][198]}

On 11 July 2022, former chief minister of Tamil Nadu Edappadi K. Palaniswami was unanimously elected as the interim general secretary of the party in the general council meeting held at the Shri Vaarū Venkatachalapathy Palace in Vanagaram, Chennai.^[199] Palaniswami appointed Dindigul C. Sreenivasan as the treasurer of the party, replacing O. Panneerselvam.^[200] On 19 July 2022, Palaniswami appointed R. B. Udhayakumar as the deputy leader of the opposition in the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly, replacing Panneerselvam, who declared this in the party's legislative members meeting held on 17 July 2022.^{[201][202]} Before the general council meeting, there was violence at the Puratchi Thalaivar M.G.R. Maaligai in Royapettah, where the supporters of Palaniswami and Panneerselvam threw stones, bottles, and plastic chairs at each other and damaged several vehicles nearby.^[203] Following this, the Revenue Department of Tamil Nadu sealed the Puratchi Thalaivar M.G.R. Maaligai. Overall, 47 people were injured in the clashes.^[204]

On 20 July 2022, the Madras High Court ordered to remove the seal of Puratchi Thalaivar M.G.R. Maaligai and hand over the keys to the interim general secretary, Edappadi K. Palaniswami.^[205] It was previously locked and sealed on 11 July 2022.^{[206][207]} On 12 September 2022, the Supreme Court of India dismissed the petition of O. Panneerselvam challenging the Madras High Court's order to handover the keys to Palaniswami.^[208]

Legal fight for the party between Edappadi K. Palaniswami and O. Panneerselvam

The Madras High Court on 17 August 2022 ruled in favor of O. Panneerselvam and declared the AIADMK general council meeting held on 11 July 2022 which had abolished dual leadership as void ab initio. The court called for the restoration of the status quo as it existed on June 23 and has prevented the party from convening any meeting of the executive council or the general council of the party without joint consent from both Palaniswami and Panneerselvam, thus effectively restoring dual leadership. The court cited procedural lapses to declare the general council meeting held on July 11, invalid and found that there was no data to prove Edappadi K. Palaniswami's claim that 95% of the 1.5 crore (15 million) primary party members supported unitary leadership under him.^{[209][210][211][212]}

Edappadi K. Palaniswami appealed the single-judge court order to a larger bench of judges.^[213] Following the order, O. Panneerselvam appealed for party unity, which included the splinter AMMK group.^[214] Palaniswami dismissed this appeal as a power-hungry move by Panneerselvam and held him responsible for violence at the Puratchi Thalaivar M.G.R. Maaligai.^[215]

On 2 September 2022, a division bench of the Madras High Court upheld the decisions of the AIADMK general council meeting held on 11 July 2022, and set aside the previous court order of the single judge in the appeal case of Edappadi K. Palaniswami, thus effectively restoring unitary leadership.^{[216][217]}

On 23 February 2023, the Supreme Court of India upheld the decisions of the AIADMK general council meeting held on 11 July 2022, and dismissed the petition of O. Panneerselvam challenging the previous order of the division bench, thus affirming unitary leadership under Edappadi K. Palaniswami.^{[218][219]} On 19 January 2024, the Supreme Court of India refused to stay the August 2023 order of the division bench of Madras High Court, which dismissed the petitions of O. Panneerselvam challenging resolutions passed by the general council held on 11 July 2022, that led to the expulsion of O. Panneerselvam and his supporters from the party, saying the interference at this stage will "lead to huge chaos".^[220]

Edappadi K. Palaniswami era (2022–present)

On 11 July 2022, an AIADMK general council meeting was held at the Shri Vaarū Venkatachalapathy Palace in Vanagaram following the dismissal of a petition by O. Panneerselvam in the Madras High Court.^[221] The party general council abolished the dual leadership model, empowered Edappadi K. Palaniswami as the party's interim general secretary, and called for organizational elections in 4 months.^[222] The general council meeting made 20 amendments to the party bylaws, including the removal of rule 20, which had described the former general secretary J. Jayalithaa as the "*eternal general secretary*"; reviving the post of general secretary; transferring all the powers of the coordinator and joint coordinator to the general secretary; and abolishing the posts of coordinator and joint coordinator. These changes in the bylaws effectively ended the dual leadership of the party.^[223]

On 28 March 2023, the Madras High Court ruled in favour of Edappadi K. Palaniswami and dismissed the petitions of O. Panneerselvam challenging the resolutions passed at the general council meeting held on 11 July 2022. On the same day, the electoral officers announced that Edappadi K. Palaniswami was elected as the general secretary of the party.^{[224][225]}

On 20 April 2023, the Election Commission of India recognised Edappadi K. Palaniswami as the general secretary of the party, acknowledging the amendments to the party constitution and changes to the list of office-bearers.^{[226][227]} On 10 July 2023, the Election Commission of India recognised the changes made in the party organisation after the party's due election.^[228]

On 20 August 2023, the Rising Conference of the AIADMK Golden Jubilee Celebrations was held in Madurai, led by the newly elected general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami, and lakhs of party cadres and supporters attended the event.^{[229][230]}



Edappadi K. Palaniswami serves as the general secretary of the party since July 2022

On 25 September 2023, the party's secretaries advisory meeting, led by general secretary [Edappadi K. Palaniswami](#), was held in the [Puratchi Thalaivar M.G.R. Maaligai](#). At the meeting, it was decided to withdraw from the [Bharatiya Janata Party-led National Democratic Alliance](#), and it was officially announced by deputy general secretary [K. P. Munusamy](#) after the meeting.^{[231][232][233]}

In the [2024 general election](#), the [AIADMK-led Alliance](#) consisting of [Desiya Murpokku Dravida Kazhagam \(DMDK\)](#), [Puthiya Tamilagam \(PT\)](#), and the [Social Democratic Party of India \(SDPI\)](#) contested in the state of [Tamil Nadu](#) and the union territories of [Puducherry](#) and [Andaman and Nicobar Islands](#) for the [18th Lok Sabha](#) polls. In the alliance, the AIADMK contested 36 constituencies, and the DMDK contested five constituencies. The party-led alliance lost in all the constituencies it contested, and the [Indian National Developmental Inclusive Alliance](#) swept the election in Tamil Nadu and Puducherry.^[234]

On 19 January 2025, Edappadi K. Palaniswami announced the formation of the "AIADMK Young Generation Sports Wing" to encourage sportspersons.^[235] On 10 February 2025, AIADMK general secretary [Edappadi K. Palaniswami](#) virtually inaugurated the newly constructed party office located at Sector-VI, Pushp Vihar, M.B. Road, [New Delhi](#), in the presence of the prominent members and secretaries of the party. The three-storey office building in the [National Capital Territory of Delhi](#) is named *Puratchi Thalaivar M.G.R. – Puratchi Thalaivi Amma Maaligai* in memory of the party's leaders and the former chief ministers of Tamil Nadu [M. G. Ramachandran](#) and [J. Jayalalithaa](#).^[236] On 11 April 2025, AIADMK General Secretary [Edappadi K. Palaniswami](#) and [BJP](#) leader and The Union Home Minister [Amit Shah](#) announced their alliance for [2026 TN Assembly election](#) on a Joint Press Conference at Chennai.^{[237][238]}

On 31 October 2025, AIADMK General Secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami expelled senior leader and Gobichettipalayam MLA [K. A. Sengottaiyan](#) from the party. Palaniswami stated that Sengottaiyan had accompanied expelled leader [O. Panneerselvam](#) and AMMK founder [T. T. V. Dhinakaran](#) in the same car and participated in a joint press conference at Pasumpon during the [Tevar Jayanthi](#) ceremony.^{[239][240][241]} Earlier on 5 September 2025, Sengottaiyan urged party general secretary Palaniswami to take steps to reunite expelled and dissenting leaders to restore the party's strength ahead of the [2026 Tamil Nadu Assembly election](#).^{[242][243]}

Electoral performance

Indian general elections

Lok Sabha Elections									
Year	Lok Sabha	Party leader	Seats contested	Seats won	Change in seats	Percentage of votes	Vote swing	Popular vote	Outcome
1977	6th	M. G. Ramachandran	21	18 / 542	▲ 18	2.90%	—	5,480,378	Government
1980	7th		24	2 / 529	▼ 16	2.36%	▼ 0.54%	4,674,064	Opposition
1984	8th		12	12 / 541	▲ 10	1.69%	▼ 0.67%	3,968,967	Government
1989	9th	J. Jayalalithaa	11	11 / 529	▼ 1	1.50%	▼ 0.19%	4,518,649	Opposition
1991	10th		11	11 / 534	—	1.62%	▲ 0.12%	4,470,542	Government
1996	11th		10	0 / 543	▼ 11	0.64%	▼ 0.98%	2,130,286	Lost
1998	12th		23	18 / 543	▲ 18	1.83%	▲ 1.19%	6,731,550	Government
1999	13th		29	10 / 543	▼ 8	1.93%	▲ 0.10%	7,046,953	Opposition
2004	14th		33	0 / 543	▼ 10	2.19%	▲ 0.26%	8,547,014	Lost
2009	15th		23	9 / 543	▲ 9	1.67%	▼ 0.52%	6,953,591	Others
2014	16th		40	37 / 543	▲ 28	3.31%	▲ 1.64%	18,111,579	
2019	17th	O. Panneerselvam and Edappadi K. Palaniswami	22	1 / 543	▼ 36	1.37%	▼ 1.94%	8,307,345	Government
2024	18th	Edappadi K. Palaniswami	36	0 / 543	▼ 1	1.39%	▲ 0.02%	8,952,587	Lost

 Karnataka Legislative Assembly Elections

Year	Assembly	Party leader	Seats contested	Seats won	Change in seats	Percentage of votes	Vote swing	Popular vote	Outcome
1978	6th	M. G. Ramachandran	7	0 / 224	—	0.18%	—	22,310	Lost
1983	7th		1	1 / 224	▲ 1	0.13%	▼ 0.05%	16,234	Opposition
1989	9th	J. Jayalalithaa	1	1 / 224	—	0.18%	▲ 0.05%	32,928	Government
1994	10th		4	1 / 224	—	0.24%	▲ 0.06%	50,696	Opposition
1999	11th		13	1 / 224	—	0.18%	▼ 0.06%	39,865	Government
2004	12th		2	0 / 224	▼ 1	0.07%	▼ 0.11%	16,737	Lost
2008	13th		7	0 / 224	—	0.03%	▼ 0.04%	9,088	
2013	14th		5	0 / 224	—	0.03%	—	10,280	
2018	15th		3	0 / 224	—	0.01%	▼ 0.02%	2,072	
		O. Panneerselvam and Edappadi K. Palaniswami							

 Kerala Legislative Assembly Elections

Year	Assembly	Party leader	Seats contested	Seats won	Change in seats	Percentage of votes	Vote swing	Popular vote	Outcome
1977	5th	M. G. Ramachandran	2	0 / 140	—	0.02%	—	2,114	Lost
1980	6th		1	0 / 140	—	0.00%	▼0.02%	224	
2006	12th	J. Jayalalithaa	29	0 / 140	—	0.12%	▲0.12%	19,078	
2011	13th		4	0 / 140	—	0.01%	▼0.11%	2,448	
2016	14th		7	0 / 140	—	0.17%	▲0.16%	33,440	
2021	15th	O. Panneerselvam and Edappadi K. Palaniswami	1	0 / 140	—	0.05%	▼0.12%	10,376	
2026	16th	Edappadi K. Palaniswami	TBA						

 Andhra Pradesh Legislative Assembly Elections

Year	Assembly	Party leader	Seats contested	Seats won	Change in seats	Percentage of votes	Vote swing	Popular vote	Outcome
1978	6th	M. G. Ramachandran	9	0 / 294	—	0.19%	—	38,691	Lost
1994	10th	J. Jayalalithaa	2	0 / 294	—	0.05%	▼ 0.14%	14,251	
1999	11th		5	0 / 294	—	0.02%	▼ 0.03%	7,281	

 Maharashtra Legislative Assembly Elections

Year	Assembly	Party leader	Seats contested	Seats won	Change in seats	Percentage of votes	Vote swing	Popular vote	Outcome
1999	10th	J. Jayalalithaa	3	0 / 288	—	0.01%	—	3,711	Lost
2009	12th		2	0 / 288	—	0.01%	—	2,587	

Current office bearers and prominent members

Member	Position in Government	Party Position
<u>Edappadi K. Palaniswami</u>	- Leader of the Opposition in the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly - Member of the Legislative Assembly from <u>Edappadi</u> - Former Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu	General Secretary
<u>A. Thamizhmahan Hussain</u>	Former Chairperson of the Tamil Nadu Waqf Board	Presidium Chairman
<u>K. P. Munusamy</u>	- Member of the Legislative Assembly from <u>Veppanahalli</u> - Former Minister for Labour of Tamil Nadu - Former Member of Parliament, Lok Sabha from <u>Krishnagiri</u>	Deputy General Secretary
<u>Dindigul C. Sreenivasan</u>	- Member of the Legislative Assembly from <u>Dindigul</u> - Former Minister for Forest of Tamil Nadu - Former Member of Parliament, Lok Sabha from <u>Dindigul</u>	Treasurer
<u>Natham R. Viswanathan</u>	- Member of the Legislative Assembly from <u>Natham</u> - Former Minister for Electricity, Prohibition and Excise of Tamil Nadu	Deputy General Secretary
<u>C. Ponnaiyan</u>	- Former Minister for Finance of Tamil Nadu - Former Member of the Legislative Assembly from <u>Tiruchengode</u>	All World M.G.R. Manram Secretary
<u>M. Thambidurai</u>	- Member of Parliament, Rajya Sabha - Former Minister of Law, Justice and Company Affairs of the Republic of India - Former Deputy Speaker of the Lok Sabha	Propaganda Secretary
<u>S. P. Velumani</u>	- Chief Whip of the Opposition in the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly - Member of the Legislative Assembly from <u>Thondamuthur</u> - Former Minister for Municipal Administration, Rural Development and Implementation of Special Programme of Tamil Nadu	Headquarters Secretary
<u>Pollachi V. Jayaraman</u>	- Member of the Legislative Assembly from <u>Pollachi</u> - Former Minister for Food and Co-operation of Tamil Nadu - Former Deputy Speaker of the Tamil Nadu legislative assembly	Election Wing Secretary
<u>B. Valarmathi</u>	- Former Minister for Social Welfare and Puratchi Thalaivar M.G.R. Nutritious Meal Programme of Tamil Nadu - Former Member of the Legislative Assembly from <u>Thousand Lights</u>	Women's Wing Secretary
<u>R. B. Udhayakumar</u>	- Deputy Leader of the Opposition in the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly - Member of the Legislative Assembly from <u>Thirumangalam</u> - Former Minister for Revenue and Disaster Management of Tamil Nadu	Puratchi Thalaivi Amma Peravai Secretary
<u>Agri S. S. Krishnamurthy</u>	- Deputy Secretary of the Opposition in the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly - Member of the Legislative Assembly from <u>Polur</u> - Former Minister for Agriculture of Tamil Nadu	Agriculture Wing Secretary
<u>P. Venugopal</u>	Former Member of Parliament, Lok Sabha from <u>Thiruvallur</u>	Medical Wing (https://aiadmkmmedicalwing.com/) Secretary
<u>Vaigaichelvan</u>	- Former Minister for School Education of Tamil Nadu - Former Member of the Legislative Assembly from <u>Aruppukottai</u>	Literary Wing Secretary
<u>R. Kamalakannan</u>	—	Anna Thozhirsanga Peravai Secretary
<u>Singai G. Ramachandran</u>	—	Students' Wing Secretary
<u>N. R. Sivapathi</u>	- Former Minister for Animal Husbandry of Tamil Nadu - Former Member of the Legislative Assembly from <u>Musiri</u>	M.G.R. Youth Wing Secretary
<u>S. T. Chellapandian</u>	- Former Minister for Labour of Tamil Nadu - Former Member of the Legislative Assembly from <u>Thoothukkudi</u>	Trade Wing Secretary

K. Sankaradas	—	Unorganised Drivers' Wing Secretary
R. V. Udayakumar	—	Arts Wing Secretary
Gayathri Raguram	—	Deputy Women's Wing Secretary
V. P. B. Paramasivam	▪ Former <u>Member</u> of the <u>Legislative Assembly</u> from <u>Vedasandur</u>	Youth Camps & Young Girls Camps Secretary
I. S. Inbadurai	▪ <u>Member of Parliament, Rajya Sabha</u> ▪ Former <u>Member</u> of the <u>Legislative Assembly</u> from <u>Radhapuram</u>	Advocates Wing Secretary
S. Abdul Rahim	▪ Former Minister for Backward Classes and Minorities Welfare of Tamil Nadu ▪ Former <u>Member</u> of the <u>Legislative Assembly</u> from <u>Avadi</u>	Minorities Welfare Wing Secretary
V. V. R. Raj Satyen	—	IT Wing Secretary

List of party leaders

General Secretaries

No.	Portrait	Name (Birth–Death)	Term in office		
			Assumed office	Left office	Time in office
1		<u>M. G. Ramachandran</u> (1917–1987)	17 October 1972	22 June 1978	6 years, 316 days
			17 October 1986	24 December 1987	
2		<u>V. R. Nedunchezhiyan</u> (1920–2000)	23 June 1978	10 June 1980	1 year, 353 days
3		<u>P. U. Shanmugam</u> (1924–2007)	11 June 1980	13 March 1985	4 years, 275 days
4		<u>S. Raghavanandam</u> (1917–1999)	14 March 1985	16 October 1986	1 year, 216 days
5		<u>J. Jayalalithaa</u> (1948–2016)	1 January 1988	5 December 2016	28 years, 339 days
Acting		<u>V. K. Sasikala</u> (b. 1954)	31 December 2016	17 February 2017	48 days
Interim		<u>Edappadi K. Palaniswami</u> (b. 1954)	11 July 2022	27 March 2023	3 years, 125 days
6			28 March 2023	<i>Incumbent</i>	

Coordinators

No.	Portrait	Name (Birth–Death)	Term in office		
			Assumed office	Left office	Time in office
1		Coordinator O. Panneerselvam (b. 1951)	21 August 2017	23 June 2022	4 years, 306 days
		Joint Coordinator Edappadi K. Palaniswami (b. 1954)			

Legislative leaders

List of cabinet ministers of the Union

No.	Portrait	Name (Birth–Death)	Portfolio	Term in office			Elected constituency (House)		
				Assumed office	Left office	Time in office			
1		<u>Sathiyavani Muthu</u> (1923–1999)	<u>Ministry of Social Welfare</u>	19 August 1979	23 December 1979	126 days	<u>Tamil Nadu</u> (<u>Rajya Sabha</u>)	<u>Charan Singh</u>	
2		<u>Aravinda Bala Pajanor</u> (1935–2013)	<u>Ministry of Petroleum, Chemicals and Fertilizers</u>				<u>Puducherry</u> (<u>Lok Sabha</u>)		
3		<u>Sedapatti R. Muthiah</u> (1945–2022)	<u>Ministry of Surface Transport</u>	19 March 1998	8 April 1998	20 days	<u>Periyakulam</u> (<u>Lok Sabha</u>)	<u>Atal Bihari Vajpayee</u>	
4		<u>M. Thambidurai</u> (b. 1947)	<u>Ministry of Law and Justice and Company Affairs</u>		8 April 1999	1 year, 20 days	1 year		
			<u>Ministry of Surface Transport</u>	8 April 1998					

List of chief ministers

Chief Ministers of Tamil Nadu

No.	Portrait	Name (Birth–Death)	Term in office			()	Elected constituency	Ministry
			Assumed office	Left office	Time in office			
1		M. G. Ramachandran (1917–1987)	30 June 1977	17 February 1980	10 years, 65 days	6th (1977)	<u>Aruppukkottai</u>	<u>Ramachandran I</u>
			9 June 1980	9 February 1985		7th (1980)	<u>Madurai West</u>	<u>Ramachandran II</u>
			10 February 1985	24 December 1987			<u>Andipatti</u>	<u>Ramachandran III</u>
Acting		V. R. Nedunchezhiyan (1920–2000)	24 December 1987	7 January 1988	14 days	8th (1984)	<u>Athoor</u>	<u>Nedunchezhiyan II</u>
2		V. N. Janaki Ramachandran (1923–1996)	7 January 1988	30 January 1988	23 days		<i>did not contest</i>	<u>Janaki</u>
3		J. Jayalalithaa (1948–2016)	24 June 1991	12 May 1996	14 years, 124 days	10th (1991)	<u>Bargur</u>	<u>Jayalalithaa I</u>
			14 May 2001	21 September 2001		12th (2001)	<i>did not contest</i>	<u>Jayalalithaa II</u>
			2 March 2002	12 May 2006			<u>Andipatti</u>	<u>Jayalalithaa III</u>
			16 May 2011	27 September 2014		14th (2011)	<u>Srirangam</u>	<u>Jayalalithaa IV</u>
			23 May 2015	22 May 2016		15th (2016)	Dr. Radhakrishnan Nagar	<u>Jayalalithaa V</u>
			23 May 2016	5 December 2016				<u>Jayalalithaa VI</u>
4		O. Panneerselvam (b. 1951)	21 September 2001	2 March 2002	1 year, 105 days	12th (2001)	<u>Periyakulam</u>	<u>Panneerselvam I</u>
			28 September 2014	23 May 2015		14th (2011)	<u>Bodinayakanur</u>	<u>Panneerselvam II</u>
			6 December 2016	15 February 2017				<u>Panneerselvam III</u>
5		Edappadi K. Palaniswami (b. 1954)	16 February 2017	6 May 2021	4 years, 79 days	15th (2016)	<u>Edappadi</u>	<u>Palaniswami</u>

Chief Minister of Puducherry

No.	Portrait	Name (Birth–Death)	Term in office			()	Elected constituency	Ministry
			Assumed office	Left office	Time in office			
1	NO IMAGE AVAILABLE	S. Ramassamy (1939–2017)	6 March 1974	28 March 1974	1 year, 155 days	4th (1974)	Karaikal South	Ramassamy I
			2 July 1977	12 November 1978		5th (1977)		Ramassamy II

List of deputy chief ministers

Deputy Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu

No.	Portrait	Name (Birth–Death)	Term in office			()	Elected constituency	_____
			Assumed office	Left office	Time in office			
1		O. Panneerselvam (b. 1951)	21 August 2017	6 May 2021	3 years, 258 days	15th (2016)	Bodinayakanur	Edappadi K. Palaniswami

List of deputy speakers of the Lok Sabha

No.	Portrait	Name (Birth–Death)	Term in office			()	Elected constituency	_____	
			Assumed office	Left office	Time in office				
1		M. Thambidurai (b. 1947)	22 January 1985	27 November 1989	9 years, 229 days	8th (1984)	Dharmapuri	Balram Jakhar	
			13 August 2014	25 May 2019		16th (2014)	Karur	Sumitra Mahajan	

List of ministers of state of the Union

No.	Portrait	Name (Birth–Death)	Portfolio	Term in office			Elected constituency (House)	Cabinet Minister		_____ _____	
				Assumed office	Left office	Time in office					
1		R. K. Kumar (1942–1999)	<u>Ministry of Parliamentary Affairs</u>	19 March 1998	22 May 1998	64 days	Tamil Nadu (Rajya Sabha)	<u>Madan Lal Khurana</u>	Atal Bihari Vajpayee		
			<u>Ministry of Finance</u>			63 days		<u>Yashwant Sinha</u>			
2		Kadambur M. R. Janarthanan (1929–2020)	<u>Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions</u>	20 March 1998	8 April 1999	1 year, 19 days	Tirunelveli (Lok Sabha)	<u>Atal Bihari Vajpayee</u>			
			<u>Ministry of Finance</u>			22 May 1998		321 days			

List of speakers

Speakers of the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly

No.	Portrait	Name (Birth–Death)	Term in office			()	Elected constituency
			Assumed office	Left office	Time in office		
1		Munu Adhi (1926–2005)	6 July 1977	18 June 1980	2 years, 348 days	6th (1977)	<u>Tambaram</u>
2		K. Rajaram (1926–2008)	21 June 1980	24 February 1985	4 years, 248 days	7th (1980)	<u>Panamarathupatti</u>
3		P. H. Pandian (1945–2020)	27 February 1985	5 February 1989	3 years, 344 days	8th (1984)	<u>Cheranmadevi</u>
4		Sedapatti R. Muthiah (1945–2022)	3 July 1991	21 May 1996	4 years, 323 days	10th (1991)	<u>Sedapatti</u>
5		K. Kalimuthu (1942–2006)	24 May 2001	1 February 2006	4 years, 253 days	12th (2001)	<u>Thirumangalam</u>
6		D. Jayakumar (b. 1960)	27 May 2011	29 September 2012	1 year, 125 days	14th (2011)	<u>Royapuram</u>
7		P. Dhanapal (b. 1951)	10 October 2012	21 May 2016	8 years, 193 days		15th (2016)
			3 June 2016	3 May 2021			

Speaker of the Puducherry Legislative Assembly

No.	Portrait	Name (Birth–Death)	Term in office			()	Elected constituency
			Assumed office	Left office	Time in office		
1	NO IMAGE AVAILABLE	S. Pakkiam (Unknown)	26 March 1974	28 March 1974	2 days	4th (1974)	<u>Bussy</u>

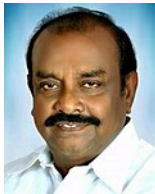
List of deputy speakers

Deputy Speakers of the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly

No.	Portrait	Name (Birth–Death)	Term in office			()	Elected constituency	_____
			Assumed office	Left office	Time in office			
1		Su. Thirunavukkarasar (b. 1949)	6 July 1977	17 February 1980	2 years, 226 days	6th (1977)	<u>Arantangi</u>	<u>Munu Adhi</u>
2		P. H. Pandian (1945–2020)	21 June 1980	15 November 1984	4 years, 147 days	7th (1980)	<u>Cheranmadevi</u>	<u>K. Rajaram</u>
3		V. P. Balasubramanian (1946–2003)	27 February 1985	30 January 1988	2 years, 337 days	8th (1984)	<u>Vedasandur</u>	<u>P. H. Pandian</u>
4		K. Ponnusamy (b. 1942)	3 July 1991	16 May 1993	1 year, 317 days	10th (1991)	<u>Marungapuri</u>	<u>Sedapatti R. Muthiah</u>
5		S. Gandhirajan (b. 1951)	27 October 1993	13 May 1996	2 years, 199 days		<u>Vedasandur</u>	
6		A. Arunachalam (b. 1948)	24 May 2001	12 May 2006	4 years, 353 days	12th (2001)	<u>Varahur</u>	<u>K. Kalimuthu</u>
7		P. Dhanapal (b. 1951)	27 May 2011	9 October 2012	1 year, 135 days	14th (2011)	<u>Rasipuram</u>	<u>D. Jayakumar</u>
8		Pollachi V. Jayaraman (b. 1952)	29 October 2012	21 May 2016	8 years, 174 days		<u>Udumalaipettai</u>	<u>P. Dhanapal</u>
			3 June 2016	3 May 2021		15th (2016)	<u>Pollachi</u>	

List of leaders of the house

Leaders of the House in the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly

No.	Portrait	Name (Birth–Death)	Term in office			()	Elected constituency
			Assumed office	Left office	Time in office		
1		<u>Nanjil K. Manoharan</u> (1929–2000)	4 July 1977	17 February 1980	2 years, 228 days	6th (1977)	<u>Palayamkottai</u>
2		<u>V. R. Nedunchezhiyan</u> (1920–2000)	19 June 1980	15 November 1984	12 years, 51 days	7th (1980)	<u>Tirunelveli</u>
			25 February 1985	6 January 1988		8th (1984)	<u>Athoor</u>
			1 July 1991	13 May 1996		10th (1991)	<u>Theni</u>
3		<u>R. M. Veerappan</u> (1926–2024)	7 January 1988	30 January 1988	23 days	8th (1984)	<u>Tirunelveli</u>
4		<u>C. Ponnaiyan</u> (b. 1942)	22 May 2001	12 May 2006	4 years, 355 days	12th (2001)	<u>Tiruchengode</u>
5		<u>O. Panneerselvam</u> (b. 1951)	23 May 2011	27 November 2014	8 years 127 days	14th (2011)	<u>Bodinayakanur</u>
			12 August 2015	21 May 2016		15th (2016)	
			25 May 2016	16 February 2017			
			4 January 2018	3 May 2021			
6		<u>Natham R. Viswanathan</u> (b. 1949)	28 November 2014	11 August 2015	256 days	14th (2011)	<u>Natham</u>
7		<u>K. A. Sengottaiyan</u> (b. 1948)	17 February 2017	3 January 2018	320 days	15th (2016)	<u>Gobichettipalayam</u>

Leader of the House in the Puducherry Legislative Assembly

No.	Portrait	Name (Birth–Death)	Term in office			()	Elected constituency
			Assumed office	Left office	Time in office		
1	NO IMAGE AVAILABLE	<u>S. Ramassamy</u> (1939–2017)	6 March 1974	28 March 1974	1 year, 155 days	4th (1974)	<u>Karaikal South</u>
			2 July 1977	12 November 1978		5th (1977)	

List of leaders of the opposition

Leaders of the Opposition in the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly

No.	Portrait	Name (Birth–Death)	Term in office			()	Elected constituency
			Assumed office	Left office	Time in office		
1		J. Jayalalithaa (1948–2016)	9 February 1989	1 December 1989	5 years, 280 days	9th (1989)	<u>Bodinayakanur</u>
			29 May 2006	14 May 2011		13th (2006)	<u>Andipatti</u>
2		S. R. Eradha (1934–2020)	1 December 1989	19 January 1991	1 year, 49 days	9th (1989)	<u>Madurai East</u>
3		O. Panneerselvam (b. 1951)	19 May 2006	28 May 2006	9 days	13th (2006)	<u>Periyakulam</u>
4		Edappadi K. Palaniswami (b. 1954)	11 May 2021	<i>Incumbent</i>	4 years, 186 days	16th (2021)	<u>Edappadi</u>

Leaders of the Opposition in the Puducherry Legislative Assembly

No.	Portrait	Name (Birth–Death)	Term in office			()	Elected constituency
			Assumed office	Left office	Time in office		
1		P. K. Loganathan (1938–2013)	16 March 1985	4 March 1990	4 years, 353 days	7th (1985)	<u>Oupalam</u>
2		V. M. C. V. Ganapathy (b. 1960)	4 July 1991	13 May 1996	4 years, 314 days	9th (1991)	<u>Neravy – T. R. Pattinam</u>

List of deputy leaders of the opposition

Deputy Leaders of the Opposition in the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly

No.	Portrait	Name (Birth–Death)	Term in office			()	Elected constituency	
			Assumed office	Left office	Time in office			
1		<u>Su. Thirunavukkarasar</u> (b. 1949)	9 February 1989	23 July 1990	1 year, 164 days	9th (1989)	<u>Aranthangi</u>	<u>J. Jayalalithaa</u> S. R. Eradha
2		<u>K. A. Sengottaiyan</u> (b. 1948)	23 June 1990	19 January 1991	189 days		13th (2006)	<u>Gobichettipalayam</u>
			19 May 2006	28 May 2006				
3		<u>O. Panneerselvam</u> (b. 1951)	29 May 2006	14 May 2011	6 years, 12 days	16th (2021)	<u>Periyakulam</u>	<u>J. Jayalalithaa</u>
			14 June 2021	11 July 2022				
4		<u>R. B. Udhayakumar</u> (b. 1973)	19 July 2022	<i>Incumbent</i>	3 years, 117 days		<u>Thirumangalam</u>	

See also

- Politics of India
- Elections in India
- AIADMK-led Alliance
- Politics of Tamil Nadu
- Elections in Tamil Nadu
- Elections in Puducherry
- List of political parties in India
- List of political parties in Tamil Nadu
- List of general secretaries of the All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam

Notes

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- Official website (<http://www.aiadmk.com/>) 
 - All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (<https://www.britannica.com/topic/All-India-Dravidian-Progressive-Federation>) at the *Encyclopædia Britannica*
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